

Marco Ferra

Engineering excellence and transformation · Delivery governance · Operational excellence

Lisbon, Portugal · hello@marcoferra.com · [linkedin.com/in/maferra](https://www.linkedin.com/in/maferra) · marcoferra.com

Full CV on request: hello@marcoferra.com

SUMMARY

I lead delivery in large, complex organisations. 18+ years across media and technology, biopharma, mobility and industrial engineering, from running an accredited laboratory with full P&L to delivery governance across a multi-team engineering organisation. I work with DORA metrics, value stream mapping, Lean Six Sigma and agile at scale. I also build and run my own product with AI, which keeps my view of delivery honest.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivery governance and DORA metrics across a large multi-team engineering organisation, with an improvement plan agreed with every team
- Enabled €20M+ in annual ancillary revenue at Hertz by leading pan-European optimisation of the rental checkout
- Grew laboratory revenue from about €400K to €900K a year at ISQ by extending the accreditation scope
- Made structured problem-solving standard practice for 300+ staff at Amgen's first capability centre in Europe

EXPERIENCE

Programme Manager, Global media and technology company

Oct 2022 to Present · Lisbon, Portugal

Delivery governance and internal improvement across a large multi-team engineering organisation.

- Instrumented DORA metrics across the engineering organisation, reviewed the results with each team and agreed a targeted improvement plan with every one
- Led the move of Jira and Confluence to Atlassian Cloud with the global PMO, giving one source of truth for delivery and portfolio data
- Embedded a standard intake process across the organisation, reaching 80% adoption
- Mapped the QA and release value streams across every codebase, and extended measurement beyond throughput into feedback loops and developer friction
- Pioneering a specification-driven, AI-assisted SDLC framework using agentic AI

Continuous Improvement Lead, Amgen

Sep 2021 to Sep 2022 · Lisbon, Portugal

Senior Manager at Amgen Capability Centre Portugal, Amgen's first capability centre in Europe. I joined three months after its launch.

- Designed and implemented the continuous improvement operating model with Deloitte Switzerland, reporting to the centre's General Manager
- Built and deployed a Lean and Kaizen curriculum for 300+ staff across 3 business units, making structured problem-solving standard practice from the centre's first year
- Led Kaizen events with A3 thinking and root-cause analysis, and mapped global processes with DMAIC and value stream mapping to remove bottlenecks

Senior Project Manager, Hertz

Jun 2019 to Sep 2021 · London, United Kingdom

International headquarters for Europe.

- Enabled €20M+ in annual ancillary revenue by leading pan-European optimisation of the rental checkout to upsell and cross-sell value-added services
- Cut online booking time by 20% through customer journey redesign, directing a cross-functional team of 15 to 20 with hybrid delivery (waterfall and agile)
- Delivered the PMO remit for the international headquarters: project charters, business cases, programme risk, governance and benefits realisation
- Ran Gemba walks in the UK and Italy to map the customer journey end to end, and led Centre of Excellence initiatives across European sites

Management Consultant, **New Angle**

Mar 2018 to Jun 2019 · Lisbon, Portugal · Part-time

Part-time, alongside ISQ. My Lean Six Sigma Black Belt course director invited me to teach and consult at his firm.

- Trained and coached 100+ professionals at multinational clients in Lean Six Sigma, Theory of Constraints and operational excellence
- Cut OPEX by 12% and raised throughput by 15% by designing and implementing a lean manufacturing system for a leading industrial equipment manufacturer

Head of Calibration Laboratory, **ISQ**

Jun 2007 to Jun 2019 · Lisbon, Portugal

Electrical and RF metrology laboratory, accredited to ISO/IEC 17025 by IPAC. Progressed from Calibration Engineer to Technical Manager to Head of Laboratory.

- Held full P&L accountability and led a 12-person team across Lisbon, Porto and Madrid, delivering 7,000 calibrations a year for Siemens, Bosch, Volkswagen and Embraer
- Grew annual revenue from about €400K to €900K by extending the accreditation scope
- Cut calibration turnaround time by 30% for the largest client through a six-month Lean Six Sigma programme and an automated scheduling platform, improving cash flow by about €150K a year
- Sustained ISO/IEC 17025 accreditation and ISO 9001 certification through successive IPAC assessments and audits, with traceability to SI units

SKILLS

Delivery and governance: Programme management, Project management, Portfolio management and PMO, Delivery governance, Agile at scale (SAFe, Scrum, Kanban), Hybrid delivery, Risk management, Business cases and benefits realisation, Stakeholder management

Engineering performance: DORA metrics, CI/CD flow, Value stream mapping (VSM), BPMN, Developer experience, AI-assisted SDLC and agentic AI, Jira and Confluence (Atlassian Cloud)

Operational excellence: Lean Six Sigma, DMAIC, Kaizen and A3 thinking, Root-cause analysis, Theory of Constraints, Continuous improvement operating models, Training and coaching

Quality and commercial: P&L management, ISO/IEC 17025, ISO 9001, Customer journey mapping, Upsell and cross-sell optimisation

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified SAFe 6 Scrum Master, Scaled Agile · valid until 25 July 2027 · ID 36103943-7660

Certified SAFe 5 Scrum Master, Scaled Agile · valid until 25 July 2027 · ID 11507811-7204

Lean Six Sigma Black Belt, 2017

Certificado de Competências Pedagógicas (CCP), Trainer, IEFP · certificate EDF 498108/2009 DL, 24 April 2009 · verifiable at netforce.iefp.pt

EDUCATION

MSc, Electrical and Computer Engineering, Instituto Superior Técnico, University of Lisbon, 2006

Postgraduate Diploma in Laboratory Management, ISQ, Lisbon, 2011

PROJECTS AND MENTORING

Founder, Astro Notes (astronotes.eu): An end-to-end encrypted notes app I build and run myself with agentic AI, from specification to production. Free for good, hosted in Germany, with no trackers.

Mentor and coach (marcoferra.com/work-with-me): I help technology, operations, product and project professionals get promoted, lead a team for the first time and manage demanding stakeholders.

SPEAKING AND PUBLICATIONS

Lean Fundamentals, Flowtopia 2026, 24 June 2026, recorded

Project Management Day 2026, Hosted by Cambridge University Press & Assessment

National and international industrial events, Keynote speaker while at ISQ, and member of a scientific committee

Reducing Calibration Time in the Electrical and Radiofrequency Laboratory, In Portuguese

EDP Wind Turbine Failure Detection, In English

LANGUAGES

English (fluent), Portuguese (native)